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PTI

For too long in Indian cricket, we've spoken about milestones, and I hope, till I'm there, we're not going to talk about milestones.

You can see it very easily as well. You can see it in the last three games, what Sanju [Samson] did - 97 not out, 89 and 89. Imagine if he had been playing for a milestone; probably we wouldn't have got 250.

So I think this is for you guys [media] as well. Stop celebrating milestones, celebrate trophies. That is going to be important because the bigger purpose of a team sport is to win trophies. Scoring personal runs has never mattered to me, and it will never matter to me.

Actually, I have been very fortunate that Suryakumar Yadav and I were on the same page, especially on this front. The best chance to give ourselves to win this World Cup was how we react when someone like a batter is close to 100. If someone is batting on 94, does he have the courage to go and get 100 next ball, rather than thinking about getting 100 in three or four balls?

I think the guys have done that brilliantly. All of them in the dressing room bought into this mindset. The only way you could hit big totals is when you're putting your team ahead of yourself. Everyone in that dressing room was putting the team ahead of himself, and that is the reason why we could achieve something special like this.

I dedicate this trophy to Rahul [Dravid] bhai and then to [VVS] Laxman. Because of what Rahul bhai has done to keep Indian cricket in such good shape, I have to thank him for everything that he's done during his tenure. And then VVS Laxman for unconditionally doing so much for Indian cricket, especially behind the scenes, because the CoE (Centre of Excellence) remains the pipeline for Indian cricket.

Third is obviously Ajit Agarkar, because he does take a lot of flak, I'm thankful for the amount of honesty he has worked with. It is not only about inheriting a team; it is also about creating something of your own.

So that is something which I wanted to do as a coach - can we play a completely different brand of cricket, where people can go and say that this is the team that has consistently outscored, outbowled, and has been a fearless group of players who do not fear losing a game of cricket.